Comparative Analysis of RPA Tools for Data-Driven Business Process

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Many organisations are still doing tasks like data entry and report generation manual. These tasks take lot of time also their is chance of human errors. To solve these problems, Robotic Process Automation (RPA) is a good solution. However, selecting the RPA tool is very confusing as different platform provide different features.

In this paper, we will compare the four most used RPA tools- UiPath, automation Anywhere, Power platform and Blue Prism. We will do so by running every platform with tasks like data entry, report generation and email handling. In this testing we will compare each platform performance based on execution time and system usage.

Keywords: Robotic Process Automation, UiPath, Automation Anywhere, Blue Prism, Business Process Automation, Comparative Study

I. Introduction

Robotic Process Automation (RPA) is now becoming an important part of improving business processes in many organisations. It helps in automating repetitive tasks by using software bots that interact with digital systems almost like a human user does [1]. Unlike traditional automation methods which need deep system integration, RPA works directly on the user interface by copying actions such as mouse clicks and keyboard inputs. Because of this reason, it can be applied faster and does not require many changes in existing systems [2]. It is generally used for tasks like moving data between systems, invoice processing, financial reconciliation, customer onboarding, and generating reports [3].

In the last few years, the RPA market has increased very quickly. It was valued around US$4.13 billion in 2023 and is expected to grow up to nearly US$23 billion by 2032, which shows a strong growth trend [4]. This growth is mainly because organisations want to improve efficiency, reduce manual mistakes, and allow employees to focus on more important work instead of doing repetitive tasks again and again [5]. Even though RPA is widely used in industries like banking, healthcare, manufacturing, and telecommunications, choosing the correct platform is still not very easy due to the large number of options available in the market [6].

There are four platforms which are mostly used: UiPath, Automation Anywhere, Blue Prism, and Microsoft Power Automate. UiPath is generally known for its easy-to-use interface and support for AI features. Automation Anywhere is more focused on cloud-based automation and intelligent capabilities. Blue Prism is usually preferred for its strong security and scalability, especially in large enterprises. Power Automate is a low-code platform and works well with other Microsoft services [7]. Although all these tools provide useful features, it is still difficult for organisations to properly compare them based on performance, scalability, and cost factors [8].

Most of the previous studies related to RPA tools mainly talk about features comparison rather than actual performance testing. Many times, these comparisons depend more on vendor-provided information instead of real experimental data [9]–[11]. Also, there is no proper standard benchmarking method available which can fairly compare execution speed, system usage, and development effort across different platforms. Because of this, organisations may face confusion while making decisions based on practical requirements.

To deal with this problem, this study focuses more on practical evaluation and comparison of RPA tools. In this work, a benchmarking approach is used based on common business-related tasks, and all platforms are tested under similar conditions. Different performance factors such as execution time, error rate, and system resource usage are measured. Apart from this, usability, scalability, and integration capabilities are also considered. The main is to study and give clear and useful understanding so that organisations can choose the most suitable RPA tool according to their needs.

The remaining part of the paper is organised as follows. Section II explains related work and identifies research gaps. Section III describes the objectives of the study. Section IV discusses the methodology and experimental setup. Section V presents implementation details. Section VI shows the results, followed by discussion in Section VII. Finally, Section VIII gives the conclusion and future scope.

II. Literature Review

A. Evolution and Definition of RPA

Robotic Process Automation, or RPA, is now widely used to handle repetitive, rule-based tasks that were once done by hand. In practical terms, it depends on software bots that move through the user interface much like a person would. As Agrawal and Varalakshmi note, this is one of RPA's major advantages, since it avoids large changes to existing systems and works directly at the interface level.

RPA did not appear suddenly. It grew out of earlier methods such as screen scraping, workflow automation, and business process management systems that were common in the late 1990s. The field began to develop much faster with the arrival of platforms like Blue Prism in 2001, Automation Anywhere in 2003, and UiPath in 2005. Microsoft later expanded its presence in this area by acquiring Softomotive in 2020 and adding automation features to the Power Platform.

B. Research Reviews and Existing Gaps

Existing research shows both the progress of RPA and the problems that still remain. Agrawal and Varalakshmi, for instance, point out that current tools often work well during the development and execution stages, while the early analysis phase is still weak. In real practice, many organizations struggle to identify which processes are actually worth automating. This is a serious weakness and it effect the whole project.

Other researchers have examined how RPA combine with the artificial intelligence. Their finding suggest that acceptance depends not only on technical strength, which is often treated as enough , but also on organisational willingness and planning.

C. Comparison of RPA Tools

There have been a number of studies that have looked at RPA platforms, but most of them focus on features instead of how well they work in real life. Khan's comparison of UiPath, Automation Anywhere, and Blue Prism shows that there are important differences in design and operation. UiPath has a lot of recording options, which makes it flexible in different situations. Automation Anywhere, on the other hand, is more focused on cloud-based automation. Blue Prism, on the other hand, has a more structured development process that requires reusable objects to be defined in advance. This adds work at the beginning, but it often makes things easier to maintain later.

Axmann et al. also compared UiPath and Power Automate by using a real-world example. Their research shows that UiPath is better for automating complicated tasks, while Power Automate works well in places that are already set up to work with Microsoft technologies. Reports from the industry, like the G2 Grid Report, back this up by showing that tools like UiPath and Blue Prism are very popular with users, especially when it comes to scalability.

D. AI and Machine Learning in RPA

The addition of AI and machine learning to RPA is one of the biggest changes. These technologies take automation to a higher level than just following rules. For instance, Rahman suggested a model that uses both machine learning and RPA to help make decisions that are both predictive and flexible.

Data from the industry backs this up. AI-enhanced automation is especially helpful for working with unstructured data like emails and documents, where traditional rule-based systems often fail. Over time, it makes things more accurate, makes fewer mistakes, and makes maintenance easier. This is a big update, not a small one. It suggests that in the future, RPA systems will rely on smart features more than just doing the same tasks over and over again.

E. Software Practices and User Interaction

Established software engineering practices also help with the implementation of RPA. Frameworks like FRIDA show that using DevOps principles along with requirements engineering can make automation solutions better. The end result is better scalability, fewer mistakes, and faster delivery. That mix is important, especially when automation projects start to grow beyond just a few small tasks.

Another important thing is how users interact with the site. Studies on how people and computers interact show that RPA tools need to be simple to use, give clear feedback, and be able to handle exceptions well. These are not small design choices. They have a direct impact on productivity and decide if users will accept the system or quietly fight it.

F. Industry Applications

RPA has made its way into a number of fields, but each one uses it in a slightly different way. In banking and healthcare, where security and governance are very important, Blue Prism is often the better choice. On the other hand, people often choose UiPath for projects that need to be built quickly or are more complicated.

Automation Anywhere works well in cloud-based environments, and Power Automate works well with Microsoft ecosystems. These differences make one thing very clear: the needs of the organization and the infrastructure that is already in place play a big role in choosing a platform. There is no one best choice for every situation.

G. User Trust and Adoption

The effectiveness of RPA is not determined by technical performance alone. User acceptance matters just as much. Reliability, transparency, and the ability to stay in control all shape how people judge automation systems. Without trust, even a well-built solution can fail to make a real difference.

Planning and governance are also essential. Research shows that many RPA initiatives break down because requirements are vague, stakeholder involvement is limited, and execution is poorly managed. That pattern is hard to ignore. It shows that technical tools must be matched with strong organizational practice if implementation is expected to succeed**.**

H. Research Gaps and Contribution

A review of the literature reveals several clear gaps. Most studies still emphasize feature comparison instead of real-world performance evaluation. There is also a lack of standardized benchmarking methods that would allow fair comparison across platforms. Important concerns such as resource usage, usability, and practical AI capability are often left out.

To address these limitations, this study uses a structured benchmarking approach. Multiple RPA platforms are tested with real-world tasks under the same conditions. Key performance indicators, including execution time, error rate, and resource utilization, are measured alongside usability and scalability. The aim is direct: to offer practical evidence that can help organizations choose the RPA tool that fits their needs most effectively**.**

III. Research Objectives

This study is focused on four RPA platforms—UiPath, Automation Anywhere, Blue Prism, and Microsoft Power Automate—and tries to compare them in situations where a lot of data-related work is involved. The idea behind it is not very complicated. It is mainly about understanding how these tools behave in real use and which one seems more suitable int different cases. One of the main things looked at is performance. This includes how fast tasks get completed, how often errors happen, and how much system resources are used while running the same kind of tasks. But performance is not enough, so working is also considered. For example, how easy it is to create workflows how much time it takes to actually learn the tool. Sometimes even small things here make a big difference in practical use.

Scalability is also checked, since in real environments the workload is not always small. The study observes how each platform handles increased load, especially when multiple bots are running together. Integration is another area that cannot be ignored. In most cases, these tools need to work with databases, emails, APIs, and other systems. If integration is not good, then it can create issues , even if the tool works fine.

Cost is also big factor, but not only in terms of price. Licensing models and overall value are looked at together, since sometimes a cheaper option may not actually be better in the long run.

IV. Methodology

A. Experiment-Design

controlled setup was use for the comparison could stay fair and the results would be reasonably trustful. All experiments were carried out on the same system, which had Windows 10 (64-bit), an Intel Core i7 processor, 16 GB RAM, and SSD storage. The same versions of the platforms—UiPath Studio, Automation Anywhere, Blue Prism, and Power Automate—were also used during the testing. .

To avoid any system-related influence, the machine was restarted before testing each platform. This helped reduce the impact of background processes, cached data, or any leftover activity from earlier runs. In this type of comparison, such steps are important; otherwise, the results may not reflect the actual performance of the tools**.**

B. Benchmark-Task-Design

To evaluate the platforms in a practical way, three common types of automation tasks were selected. The first task is data entry. A CSV file containing 100 records was used, and the platform had to read the file and input the data into an Excel sheet. This task check how well each tool work with structured data-automation.
The second task focused on report generation. It used sales-related data, where totals and simple statistics had to be calculated, followed by creating a formatted report with charts. This helped in understanding both processing capability and reporting features.

The third task involved email processing. Emails with attachments were taken, and important details, such as order-related information, were extracted and stored in a database. All the datasets used here were artificially created. This was done mainly to maintain consistency across tests and also to avoid any privacy-related concerns..

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C. Metrics Definition

Performance Metrics:

Metric	Measurement Method
Execution Time	Total process duration averaged over five runs
Error Rate	Percentage of processed records resulting in exceptions
CPU Utilization	Peak and average CPU percentage during execution
Memory Utilization	Peak working set size (MB)
Throughput	Records processed per minute

Usability Metrics:

Metric	Measurement Method
Development Effort	Total person-hours to implement workflows
Workflow Complexity	Activities/actions/objects/steps in workflow
Recorder Effectiveness	Qualitative accuracy assessment

D. Test Protocol

All workflows were implemented by the same developer to maintain consistency. Standard practices such as proper error handling, logging, and resource management were followed during implementation.

Each task was executed five times on every platform, and the system state was checked before each run. No major outliers were observed in the results. Resource usage and error rates were recorded throughout the execution to ensure accurate measurement.

V. Platform Implementation

In this section, we include references to the architectural design of the RPA platforms.

Fig. 1 shows a high-level overview of the architecture of the four platforms considered in this study. The implementation approach for each platform is described below

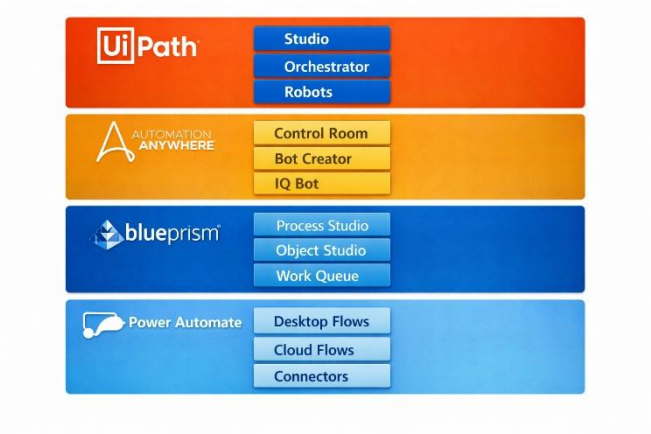

Fig. 1: Architecture Overview of RPA Platforms

A.UiPath-Implementation

The UiPath workflows were built in UiPath Studio 2025.10, with Orchestrator used to schedule jobs and monitor execution. The setup relied on several built-in activities, including reading CSV files, handling Excel operations, generating PDF reports, and retrieving emails through IMAP. This part was fairly direct, since UiPath already provides strong native support for these routine automation tasks.

For scalability testing, parallel execution was arranged by splitting tasks across two robots through Orchestrator. Each robot handled part of the dataset. This was important, honestly, because it gave a clearer view of how the process behaved when multiple executions were running at the same time rather than in a neat single-robot test**.**

B.Automation-Anywhere-Implementation

Automation Anywhere, specifically Automation 360 v23.1, was deployed in cloud mode. Bot Creator was used for bot development, while Control Room managed execution and monitoring. Built-in commands supported CSV processing, and separate packages were applied for Excel, PDF, and email-automation.
In a few situations, IQ Bot was brought in to handle semi-structured attachments. That improved extraction quality, especially where the input was not clean or fully predictable, which is usually where automation starts becoming **frustrating.**

C.Blue_Prism-Implementation

Blue Prism v7.1 was configured in a single-machine environment using Process Studio. Visual Business Objects were develop for key applications like Excel, email, and file system operations. A Work line was set up to assign tasks to the robot, which made the execution flow more controlled and easier to manage. Exception handling and recovery stages were added across the process to improve reliability. The Work line was also monitored during runtime, and that

mattered a lot because Blue Prism relies heavily on stable queue management

D.Power-Automate-Implementation

Power Automate used both desktop flows and cloud flows. Desktop flows handle interface work, especially Excel interaction and data extraction. Cloud flows manage email processing through the Microsoft 365 Outlook and supported database integration through HTTP requests.

VI. Results

Table I presents execution time, error rate, and resource utilization measurements for each platform across benchmark tasks. Values represent means over five runs

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Platform	Task	Time (s)	Error Rate	CPU (%)	Memory (MB)	Throughput (rec/min)
UiPath	Data Entry	12.3	0.0%	45	352	488
	Report Gen	20.1	0.0%	50	398	149
	Email Proc	18.7	0.0%	42	335	32
Automation Anywhere	Data Entry	15.2	0.0%	50	368	395
	Report Gen	24.8	0.0%	55	422	121
	Email Proc	22.3	0.0%	48	388	27
Blue Prism	Data Entry	18.1	0.0%	35	302	332
	Report Gen	28.3	0.0%	40	348	106
	Email Proc	25.6	0.0%	38	315	23
Power Automate	Data Entry	20.4	0.0%	62	452	294
	Report Gen	30.6	0.0%	68	485	98
	Email Proc	27.8	0.0%	58	428	22

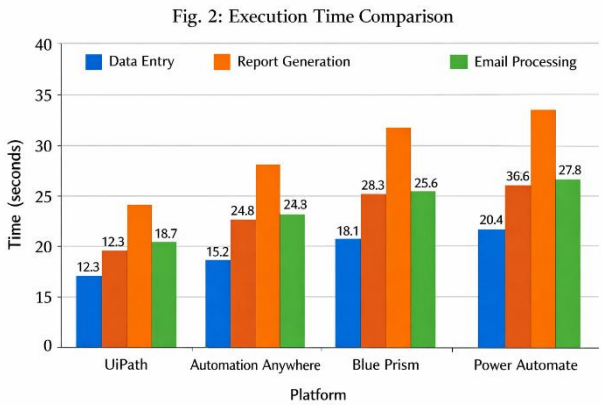

Fig. 2: Execution Time Comparison Across RPA Platforms

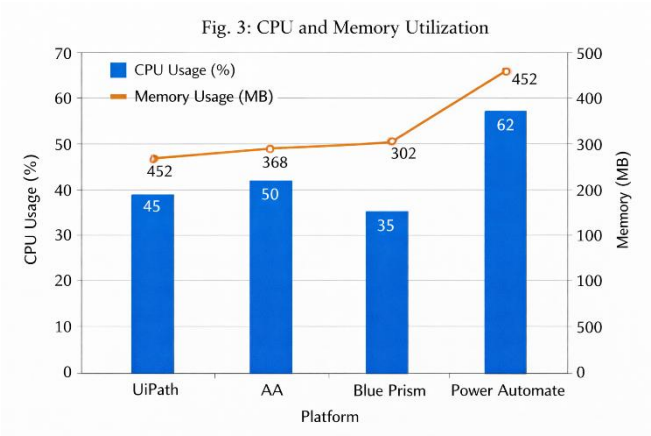

Fig. 3: CPU and Memory Utilization Comparison

Table II presents the results of parallel execution testing for the data entry task using two concurrent bots:

Platform	Single (s)	Dual (s)	Gain (%)
UiPath	12.3	9.8	20.3
Automation Anywhere	15.2	11.5	24.3
Blue Prism	18.1	13.2	27.1

Power Automate	20.4	16.8	17.6

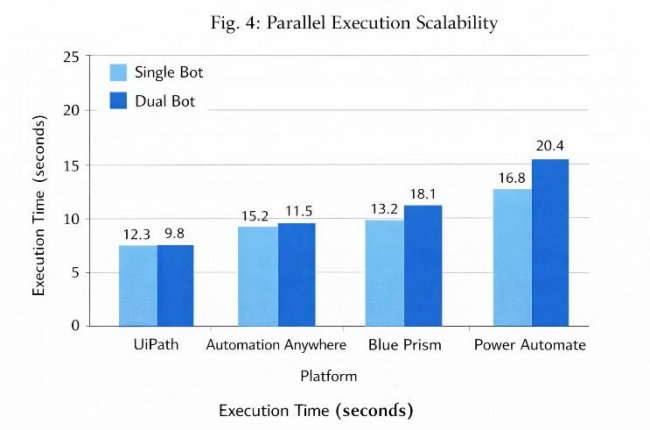

Fig. 4: Parallel Execution Scalability

Table III summarizes development metrics across platforms:

Platform	Data Entry (hr)	Report Gen (hr)	Email Proc (hr)	Total (hr)	Total Activities/Steps
UiPath	1.5	1.7	1.8	5.0	187
Automation Anywhere	2.0	2.2	2.1	6.3	156
Blue Prism	3.0	3.2	3.5	9.7	142
Power Automate	1.8	2.0	2.5	6.3	168

Table IV provides qualitative assessment of integration capabilities:

Capability	UiPath	Automation Anywhere	Blue Prism	Power Automate
REST API	Native	Native	VBO required	Native (HTTP)
Database Connectors	Extensive	Extensive	VBO required	Limited (SQL)
Email (IMAP/SMTP)	Native	Native	Native (VBO)	Native (Outlook)
SAP Integration	Premium	Premium	Native	Limited
Custom .NET Libraries	Native	Via API	Via COM	Via API
RPA Recorders	5 types	3 types	None	Limited

VII. Discussion

A. Performance Trade-offs

The results point to pretty obvious performance gaps between the platforms, and most of that seems to come from how each one is built and how it runs tasks.

UiPath was clearly the fastest in every task tested. In the data entry task, for instance, it finished in 12.3 seconds, while the others took from 15.2 to 20.4 seconds. That is not a small difference. It shows UiPath likely has a more efficient execution engine and stronger task handling overall. Looking at the full set of results, it stayed about 20–40% faster than the competing platforms, which is hard to ignore.

Blue Prism, meanwhile, stood out more for resource efficiency than raw speed. Its CPU usage stayed around 35–40%, and memory use ranged from 302 to 348 MB, both lower than the others. That sounds good, though the trade-off is pretty clear: it ran about 40–50% slower than UiPath. To me, that makes Blue Prism feel more focused on stability and careful resource control than on finishing tasks quickly.

Power Automate used the most resources, with CPU at 58–68% and memory at 428–485 MB. That probably connects to its desktop automation model. Even then, for companies already deep in Microsoft tools, that cost may still be worth it.

B. Development Productivity Implications

Development time differed a lot across the platforms, landing somewhere between about 5 and 9.7 hours. That gap matters more than it first seems, since it has a direct effect on implementation cost and also how fast a solution can actually go-live.
UiPath took the least effort to build in. Honestly, that makes sense because its interface is easier to work with, the recording options are practical, and the activity library is broad enough to save time. Blue Prism, on the other hand, needed more time. Its method is more rigid, with objects and processes defined first before anything really moves. That slows the start, definitely, though it usually pays off later through better maintainability and reuse.

C. Scalability and Enterprise Readiness

For scalability and enterprise use, all four platforms can handle heavier workloads with parallel execution, though

they do it differently. Blue Prism stands out most to me because its work queue model is strong, especially when tasks need clear priority and failures have to be managed properly. Automation Anywhere depends more on cloud architecture for flexibility, while UiPath uses Orchestrator effectively. Power Automate grows through Microsoft's cloud setup..

D. Cost-Effectiveness Framework

Licensing models vary significantly across platforms. Table V summarizes approximate costs and considerations.

Platform	Model	Cost (Approx.)	Notes
UiPath	User/Bot	$15k–25k/bot	Extra AI cost
Automation Anywhere	Cloud	$9k–18k/bot	IQ Bot included
Blue Prism	Digital Worker	$12k–18k/worker	Extra add-ons
Power Automate	User/Flow	$40/user/month	Unlimited flows

The most suitable option depends on usage requirements. For occasional or small-scale automation, Power Automate may be more cost-effective. However, for continuous, large-scale automation, enterprise platforms with subscription-based models may provide better value.

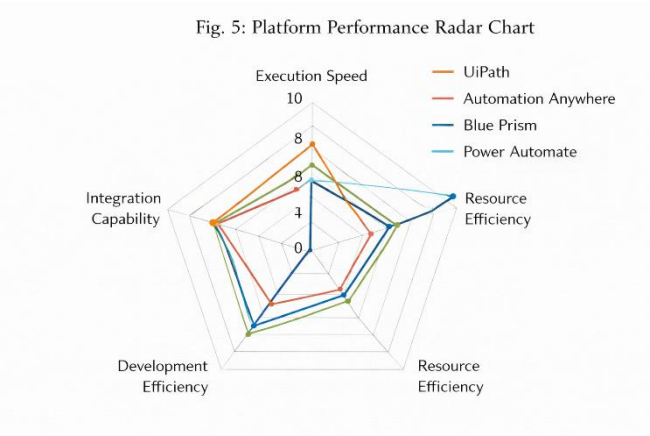

Fig.5:PerformanceRadarChart

E. Limitations

This study has some limitations that should be considered.

- The experiments were done on just one machine, and that really limits how far the results can go. It doesn't fully reflect the complexity or pressure of large enterprise environments.
- Only three task types were tested, even though real automation work is usually far more varied and messy.
- Every workflow came from one developer, so the results could shift quite a bit with someone else's skill level.
- RPA tools keep changing, which honestly matters, and newer versions may produce different outcomes.
- Error handling was checked in controlled settings, not in the more complicated situations people actually face.

VIII. Conclusion and Future Work

A. Summary of Findings

This study compares different RPA platforms for data-driven business tasks using a structured approach. It evaluates multiple factors, not only execution speed but also system resource usage, development effort, and scalability.

The results highlight noticeable differences between the platforms. UiPath performed consistently well across almost all tasks, including data entry, report generation, and email processing. In many cases, it was around 20–40% faster than the others, while maintaining moderate CPU and memory usage. This balance between performance and efficiency makes UiPath a strong option.

Blue Prism, on the other hand, showed better resource efficiency. It generally consumed less CPU and memory compared to the other platforms, which makes it suitable for environments where stability and predictable performance are more important than speed. However, its execution time was usually higher.

Power Automate appeared to be a practical choice for organizations already using the Microsoft ecosystem. Its built-in integrations and relatively lower cost make it suitable for small to medium-scale automation tasks.

Development effort also varied significantly. UiPath required less development time due to its more user-friendly design, whereas Blue Prism took longer because of its structured approach. At the same time, this structure can be beneficial for long-term maintenance and governance. All platforms supported parallel execution, which improved performance by approximately 18–27%, although each platform handled scaling differently.

B. Selection Guidance

Based on these findings, we recommend:

Context	Platform
High-volume	UiPath
Regulated	Blue Prism

Document-heavy	Automation Anywhere	[3] S. Khan, "Comparative Analysis of RPA Tools – UiPath, Automation Anywhere & Blue Prism," *International Journal of Computer Science and Mobile Applications*.	IQ Bot, handl unstructured data
Microsoft-based	Power Automate	[4] G2, "Grid Report for Robotic Process Automation (RPA) – Winter 2025."	Office integration, cost
Mixed systems	UiPath / Automation Anywhere	[5] S. M. M. Rahman, "Enhancing Pega Robotics Process Automation with Machine Learning," in *IEEE Int. Conf. Computing and Applications*, Kuala Lumpur, 2024.	Wide connecto flexible deployment

C. Future Research Directions

The biggest one, in my view, is stronger integration of artificial intelligence, especially machine learning, natural language processing, and computer vision. Those areas matter because unstructured data is still a stubborn problem in many automation settings, and current approaches often do not deal with it very well. Cost evaluation also needs a more serious treatment. A useful cost model should not stop at licensing fees. It has to include infrastructure, development effort, and long-term maintenance too. Looking only at the starting price gives a narrow picture, and honestly, that can push people toward conclusions that are too simple.

Another issue that deserves more attention is the multi-platform environment. Many organizations use more than one RPA tool at once. That is normal in practice, yet a lot of research keeps judging platforms one by one, which feels disconnected from how companies actually work.

Long-term maintainability should be examined much more closely as well. System updates, technical debt, and changes in performance over time can quietly create major problems, though they are often treated like side issues.

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